

Peas and beans

Flowering plants

Winged beans

Four frilly wings run along the length of each edible pod.

Fava beans

These flattened beans grow to 1 in (2.5 cm) in length.

Runner beans

Pink beans or young seed pods are both popular side dishes.

Each small pod contains two circular seeds.

Lentils

Lentils are rich in vitamins and minerals.

Up to 14 beans are produced per pod.

Adzuki beans

Lima beans

These pale beans have a buttery texture and flavor.

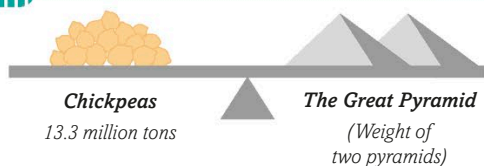
Black-eyed peas

Its distinct black spots give this seed its name.

Chickpeas

Short pods contain two or three edible seeds.

CHICKPEAS GALORE



The world produced 13.3 million tons of chickpeas in 2016, most of which was grown in India. This harvest weighed twice as much as the Great Pyramid of Giza in Egypt, known to weigh 6.5 million tons.

Peas, beans, and lentils are types of seeds known as pulses. They are rich in proteins, fiber, and nutrients and have been eaten by humans around the world for thousands of years. Today, India is the biggest grower and consumer of pulses, particularly lentils.

Humans started farming pulses because their seeds can be easily dried and stored for when food is scarce. **Lentils** are one of our oldest crops, with archaeological evidence showing that humans ate them more than 13,000 years ago in Greece, while 7,500-year-old **chickpeas** have been found in excavations in Turkey.